

Emissions per person down 44%, or off track for 2030?

A public claim, tested against EU and Eurostat data

THE CLAIM

“Emissions per capita have fallen by 44% since 2005, well above the EU average of 34%.”

Climate Action Authority, press release, 13 November 2025

Citing the European Commission's Climate Action Progress Report 2025.

The same EU report projects Malta will miss its 2030 target by the widest margin in the EU in percentage points.

VERDICT

MISLEADING

*Accurate numbers,
incomplete picture.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

–44%

The figure is right

Eurostat data reproduce the per-person fall (EU: –34%). Power-sector emissions fell 63%.

+41%

Population growth since 2005

About half the per-person fall is more people, not fewer emissions. In total tonnes Malta cut 27%, the EU 33%.

+49%

Transport since 2005

Buildings and air-conditioning gases rose too: the sectors closest to households went up, not down.

+41%

Target-sector emissions, 2024

Emissions in the sectors under Malta's binding 2030 target (–19%) were 41% above 2005 in 2024.

49 pts

Projected 2030 gap

Even with planned measures the Commission projects +30%: the EU's largest gap in percentage points.

FAIR TO SAY

Cutting power-sector emissions by almost two-thirds was a real achievement, and per-person figures are a standard indicator. This check is about what the press release leaves out.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The source and scope of the 44% and 34% figures.

☐ What “40% by 2030” covers: total or target sectors?

☐ A dated plan taking target-sector emissions from +41% to –19%.

☐ How much Malta expects to rely on buying allocations.